

Word family: **lifeless / lifelessly / lifelessness / life**

Base word: lifeless

Related forms: lifelessly, lifelessness

Related base family: life

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “The atmosphere is quiet but not **lifeless**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **lifeless** means **lacking energy, warmth, activity, or liveliness**.

The speaker means the library is quiet, but it does **not** feel dull, dead, empty, or without atmosphere.

繁體中文： **沒有生氣的；沉悶的；缺乏活力或氣氛的**

中文翻譯：

> “The atmosphere is quiet but not **lifeless**.”

「那裡的氣氛很安靜，但並不是**死氣沉沉 / 毫無生氣**。」

Here:

lifeless = 缺乏活力、溫度、氣氛或動感

1. **lifeless = dead / no longer alive (沒有生命) — 無生命的；死的**

Meaning: Not alive, or no longer living.

Practice 1

> “The bird lay **lifeless** on the ground.”

「那隻鳥**毫無生命跡象**地躺在地上。」

Practice 2

> “His body was found **lifeless**.”

「人們發現他的身體時已經**沒有生命跡象**。」

****lifeless = 已經沒有生命或完全沒有生命跡象的****

This is the most literal sense.

2. ****lifeless = dull / lacking energy or atmosphere (氣氛) — 死氣沉沉的 ; 沒有活力的****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The atmosphere is quiet but not ****lifeless****.”

「那裡的氣氛很安靜，但並不****死氣沉沉****。」

Practice 4

> “The room felt cold and ****lifeless****.”

「那個房間感覺冰冷又****毫無生氣****。」

Practice 5

> “Without people, the square looked strangely ****lifeless****.”

「沒有人時，那個廣場看起來異常****死氣沉沉****。」

****lifeless = 缺乏活力、氣氛、溫度或動感，讓人感覺沉悶、空洞****

This is a major figurative sense.

3. ****lifeless = expressionless / without animation (人 / 臉 / 聲音) — 呆滯的 ; 毫無表情的****

****Lifeless**** can describe someone's face, eyes, voice, or manner when it seems to have no energy or emotional expression.

Practice 6

> “His eyes looked ****lifeless****.”

「他的眼神看起來很****呆滯 / 毫無神采****。」

Practice 7

> “She spoke in a flat, **lifeless** voice.”

「她用一種平淡而**毫無生氣**的聲音說話。」

lifeless = 表情、眼神、聲音或動作缺乏情緒、精神或活力

This is related to Meaning 2 but useful enough to show explicitly.

4. **lifeless** = lacking movement or activity (動態) — 靜止的 ; 沒有活動的

A place, scene, object, or body can be described as **lifeless** if nothing seems to move or happen.

Practice 8

> “The street looked completely **lifeless** at midnight.”

「午夜時那條街看起來完全**毫無動靜**。」

Practice 9

> “The landscape seemed dry and **lifeless**.”

「那片景觀看起來乾枯而**缺乏生命氣息**。」

lifeless = 沒有明顯活動、動作或生命跡象

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2.

5. **lifeless** = flat / unconvincing in art or performance (作品 / 表演) — 生硬的 ; 沒有感染力的

Lifeless can describe writing, acting, music, art, design, etc. that feels dull and lacks energy or emotional force.

Practice 10

> “The performance was technically correct but **lifeless**.”

「這場表演技術上沒有問題，但很**沒有感染力 / 缺乏生氣**。」

Practice 11

> “The dialogue felt **lifeless**.”

「那些對白感覺很**生硬、毫無生氣**。」

****lifeless = 作品或表演缺乏感染力、活力或自然感****

This is a useful figurative branch.

Related form: ****lifelessly****

****Lifelessly**** means in a way that lacks energy, expression, or signs of life.

Practice 12

> “His arms hung ****lifelessly**** by his sides.”

「他的雙臂**無力地 / 毫無生氣地**垂在身旁。」

This form is valid but not especially common.

Related form: ****lifelessness****

****Lifelessness**** means the quality or state of being lifeless.

Practice 13

> “The ****lifelessness**** of the room made it uncomfortable.”

「房間那種**死氣沉沉的感覺**令人不舒服。」

****lifelessness = 缺乏生命、活力、氣氛或表情的狀態****

Important distinction: ****lifeless vs dead****

****dead****

literally means no longer alive.

lifeless

can mean either:

- * literally dead

- * figuratively dull, flat, or without energy

So:

> dead body

is direct and literal.

> lifeless atmosphere

is figurative.

Important distinction: **lifeless vs quiet**

This matters directly in your passage.

quiet

means:

- * little noise

- * calm

- * not much activity

lifeless

means:

- * lacking energy

- * dull

- * without atmosphere

A place can be quiet but still pleasant, warm, and full of life.

That is exactly what your sentence says.

Important distinction: **lifeless vs dull**

dull

is broad and can mean boring, uninteresting, or lacking brightness.

lifeless

suggests something feels almost as if it has no life or energy.

> dull lecture

> lifeless performance

Lifeless is more vivid.

Important distinction: **lifeless vs empty**

empty

means containing nothing or nobody.

lifeless

means lacking energy or vitality.

A room can be full of people and still feel lifeless.

Important distinction: **lifeless vs expressionless**

expressionless

specifically means showing no emotion in the face/voice.

lifeless

is broader and can suggest no energy, spirit, or animation at all.

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

* **lifeless**
* **lifelessly**
* **lifelessness**

The core word **life** is already a broader lexical base, while **lifeless** has developed a clear figurative branch from literal absence of life to absence of energy or atmosphere.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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lifeless — literally not alive	已經沒有生命或完全沒有生命跡象的
lifeless — atmosphere/place	缺乏活力、氣氛、溫度或動感；死氣沉沉的
lifeless — face/voice/person	缺乏表情、精神或情緒；呆滯的、毫無神采的
lifeless — art/performance	缺乏感染力、自然感或活力的
lifelessly	毫無生氣地；呆滯地；無力地
lifelessness	缺乏生命、活力或氣氛的狀態

For your original sentence

> “The atmosphere is quiet but not **lifeless**.”

The exact meaning is:

lifeless = 沒有生氣、沉悶、缺乏活力或氣氛

So:

> **quiet but not lifeless**

= **安靜，但並不死氣沉沉**

The sentence contrasts **calmness** with **dullness**.

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **lifeless**:

1. **literally not alive**
2. **figuratively dull / lacking energy or atmosphere**
3. **lacking expression, animation, or emotional force**

I would merge place/activity/artistic uses mostly into #2/#3 rather than inflate the count.